

FACHABITURPRÜFUNG 2025

zum Erwerb der Fachhochschulreife
an Fachoberschulen und Berufsoberschulen

ENGLISCH

Montag, 2. Juni 2025

READING COMPREHENSION TEXTS

Prüfungsbeginn: 09:00 Uhr

Diese Prüfung besteht aus zwei Teilen:

READING: Tasks I - III (9:00 bis 10:30 Uhr)

Organisatorische Pause

WRITING: Material-Based Writing (60 Minuten)

Im **READING**-Teil werden Texte und Aufgaben in zwei getrennten Geheften vorgelegt.

Die Aufgaben (**TASKS**) liegen in zwei Varianten (**V1** und **V2**) vor.

Diese sind gemischt auszugeben.

Alle Lösungen sind von den Prüflingen im Aufgabengeheft einzutragen.

In der Pause werden die Text- und Aufgabengehefte von den Arbeitsplätzen der Schüler entfernt.

Der **WRITING**-Teil wird erst nach der organisatorischen Pause ausgegeben.

Hilfsmittel: Ein einsprachiges Wörterbuch (ggf. auch inkl. Writing Tutor)

Reading Text I: Ski Resorts Are Stockpiling Snow To Get Through Warm Winters

Under protective coverings, piles of snow can be stored for a surprisingly long time, allowing ski resorts to mitigate some of the lack of snowfall caused by climate change.

It's time to check on the snow pile. In mid-August, Marko Mustonen, commercial director of Levi ski resort in northern Finland, logs on to a live webcam view of an elongated heap of snow snaking down a hillside. He shares his screen with me on Zoom so that I too may observe the precious hoard. The snow is neatly covered by thick, white, insulating blankets—and surrounded by grassy green terrain.

"It's looking very good," Mustonen remarks. "This is the biggest amount of snow we have ever stored. I think we are reaching the optimum." Four separate stockpiles like this one at Levi amount to a total of 260,000 cubic meters of snow, enough to fill 100 Olympic swimming pools. It is one of the largest snow-storing operations in the world. With this hefty supply at hand, Levi can more or less guarantee opening some key ski routes in November without having to rely on natural snowfall.

As the climate warms, ski destinations in some parts of the world are facing a crisis: not enough snow. It is a problem that has shuttered some resorts for good. One way to combat a lack of snow is to produce it artificially with huge machines—sometimes working around the clock, for days on end. But this is energy intensive and requires relatively low outdoor temperatures. Proponents of snow storage, meanwhile, argue that it allows resorts to make artificial snow cheaply, when conditions are most favorable, and then keep it until it is needed. Storing natural snow is also possible. Snow storage even has industrial applications. It can be used to supply cooling systems in large buildings during hot summers, for instance.

The company behind the insulating blanket system used by Levi and dozens of other resorts in Europe to preserve their snow during summer is Snow Secure, based in Finland. "We provide 100 percent snow security," says Antti Lauslahti, Snow Secure's CEO, proudly. "Any ski resort can start the season at a specific date." It's not just ski resorts that can make use of stored snow. One of Snow Secure's clients is a timber-processing plant. Staff there keep large pieces of wood under a thick layer of snow topped with the blankets. It keeps the timber from drying out too much in the summer, ensuring that it stays fresh and easy to cut, says Lauslahti.

Elizabeth Burakowski at the University of New Hampshire says that, in general, snow storage is "a great strategy to address the uncertainty that we have when living in a climate that's warming rapidly." She adds that ski resorts have to consider using electric-powered snow-grooming machines, to reduce emissions and reliance on fossil fuels.

Snow Secure is keen to promote its blanket system. But there is another way of covering up a big ol' heap of snow and insulating it for months on end. And it has been used for centuries. You can just spread sawdust or wood chips over the snow instead. "It's an elegant technology," says Kjell Skogsberg, who works in the renewable energy industry. "It's really reliable and simple."

35 Back in 2001, Skogsberg and a colleague published a paper about a snow-storage system they had designed for a hospital in Sundsvall, in eastern Sweden. "It's like a pit with a slightly sloping bottom where you dump the snow," he explains. The snow is topped with a 200-millimeter-thick covering of wood chips to prevent it from melting too quickly. Then, over the summer, meltwater
40 gently flows to an outlet at the bottom corner of the pit, passing through filters that remove any grit or dirt, and finally the chilly water heads to a heat exchanger. This helps to lower the temperature of a separate flow of water that gets pumped through the hospital's cooling system.

"That is used for air conditioning and also process cooling—for instance, X-ray machines," says Skogsberg. The system is still in use today, he adds, and it can completely cover the energy demand for summer cooling at the hospital, which, at 1 gigawatt hour for the May–August
45 period, is significant. Skogsberg is currently in discussions with an energy company that might build a version of the technology for a district cooling system. Airports, which have a lot of outdoor space that could also be used to store snow, might similarly find this approach useful, suggests Skogsberg.

50 Could we cover melting glaciers with wood chips to preserve them—as an alternative to the blankets that are already being tried in some locations in Europe? The problem there might be one of scale, suggests Burakowski: "It's a labor-intensive task. It requires a lot of resources to get that much material up there."

Paul Bierman, running the Craftsbury Outdoor Center in Vermont, agrees. We should be putting
55 our efforts into decarbonization instead, he argues. And while he says he is a "huge fan" of snow storage as an interim solution that could keep local resorts open, reducing people's desire to travel great distances just to ski each winter, the long-term picture is currently rather bleak, though. "This is all one giant Band-Aid over the fact that we are rapidly warming Earth's climate," says Bierman. "It's great for the moment, but I can't imagine this lasting."

Reading Text II:

A Bulwark Against Misinformation, Local Newspapers Matter More Than Ever

[A] As a kid, I remember my mom used to get the Sunday paper. I haven't seen one in a while, but back then, the Sunday paper was a monstrosity. It came in this huge bundle with the newspaper on the outside, but inside, it was stuffed with advertisements, mailers, coupons, and sometimes even a special Sunday-edition magazine of some sort. I don't remember these Sunday papers because I loved the news. I'm not judging if you were that kind of kid, but I was not. I remember the Sunday papers because of the comics section. My mom would get upset with me because I would rifle through the paper for the comics section before she had a chance to look at it, leaving her to rearrange the paper back into orderly sections. [...]

[B] Fast forward some 20 years later, I was a law school graduate delivering newspapers. This very newspaper, in fact. I would get up at 11 p.m. or midnight, eventually make my way to the warehouse, pack up my papers, load them into my car, and finish deliveries by 5:30 a.m. After that, I would head into work at the Cleveland Housing Court. Not a lot of sleep those days. Fast forward some five or so years after that, and I was a community member of the Editorial Board of this newspaper. Two years after that, I was granted this column that you are now reading. I say all of that to explain why the newspaper holds a bit of a special place for me. It's not the same as someone with a journalism degree, or who has been a reporter for their career, no. But the newspaper is, in a sense, a kind of a golden thread for me. I experience a sense of nostalgia when I think about newspapers.

[C] When I read about the recent mass layoffs at the Los Angeles Times, I immediately felt a sense of sadness. For some time now, the newspaper industry, with some exceptions, has been on a decline. Readership is declining. Consequently, circulation is declining. Thus, advertising is declining. There's a lot of blame being fairly placed on the internet. It's simple economics for most people. The newspaper has a cost. Facebook doesn't. What I think people miss is that there is a cost associated with the demise of newspapers. It is a societal cost that we are paying every day. And the cost will only increase as the newspaper industry's decline continues.

[D] One cost that we are paying is the proliferation of misinformation. The internet, in large part, is a scramble for consumers' attention. Misinformation gets attention. And it can travel 10 times faster than legitimate news stories. Corrections are rarely as viral. This leaves us in a world where many of us have opinions on issues both large and small rooted in "facts" that are not true. And given the way our minds process information to confirm our own biases, it is almost Sisyphean to try to convince people of the truth. This problem is so pervasive that the World Economic Forum recently named false and misleading information as the top immediate risk to the global economy.

[E] Say what you want about newspapers. Yes, they can have clear political leanings. Yes, sometimes information is inaccurately reported. But no reasonable person can accurately

describe newspapers as bastions of misinformation. Their flaws can be easily explained by the fact that they are organizations comprised of people, who themselves are flawed. Misinformation on the internet is fueled both by the economics of the internet and the worst parts of human behavior that thrive under the shroud of anonymity.

40 [F] Another cost that we are paying is the loss of information: specifically, local information. Said simply, there is no organization that covers local news and politics like a local newspaper. Local news stations, try as they might, don't quite cut it. A newspaper covers a lot more ground than your local news at 5 p.m. The economics of the internet don't incentivize attending City Council committee meetings. "Entertaining" things don't happen during these meetings. Important
45 things do. The demise of the newspaper industry would be the demise of the watchdog over local politics. It's cliché to distrust politicians. But behind this cliché are the numerous instances of newspapers catching politicians in dishonesty and telling us about it. In the case of elected officials being less than truthful or outright dishonest, it is indisputable that what you don't know can in fact hurt you. Without newspapers, the harm which is caused by the lack of knowledge
50 will only increase.

[G] What will it mean to be an informed citizen 50 years from now? [...] What will be considered a "fact" to a generation of children perpetually bombarded with misinformation? Will a fact's virality equal its truth? Finding the truth is harder in a digital environment. Will they possess the patience (or desire, even) to double-check and triple-check information to verify its accuracy?
55 Only time will tell the answers to these questions. And I don't know if it's reasonable to expect some radical reversal where people go back to getting their news from traditional print. But in the meantime, newspapers will always have at least one subscriber: Yours truly.

Reading Text III:

We Are Not Like Them – Not Every Story Is Black And White

Jen and Riley have been best friends since kindergarten. As adults, they remain as close as sisters, though their lives have taken different directions. But the deep bond they share is severely tested by a tragic event.

5 It takes everything I have not to turn and bolt out the door. Coming here was a mistake, I see that now, but I can't leave. I can't do anything except slink into the booth across from Riley, who stares at me like I'm a stranger. She's waiting for me to say something, **face as blank as an empty canvas**. I have no idea what to say. I'm sorry? But what am I sorry for exactly, and why am I apologizing to Riley?

Finally, almost like she's taking pity on me, she says, "How are you?"

I didn't know what to expect; she hasn't returned any of my calls this weekend, but her concern is such a mercy that I feel a flicker of hope.

10 "I'm okay, I guess. But ... it doesn't matter how I feel." I sound like a martyr, but there are more important things I want to explain. I plant my damp palms on the table, ready to launch into the speech I practiced a thousand times on the way over.

15 "Listen, Riley, Kevin thought he was chasing a guy who had just shot someone. He thought there was a gun. He feared for his life." I stop short of saying it was Cameron's fault, even though I'm completely convinced of that. He shot first, so Kevin had to open fire. Cameron was inexperienced; he made the bad call. If Kevin had been with Ramirez, this never would have happened. Maybe I'm being overly defensive, but it's just that I want—I need—Riley to know.

20 I search her expression for any trace of understanding, trying to gauge the likelihood that she'll say what I so desperately need her to say: I'm here for you. There's a hard glint in her eyes—it passes in a blink, but it's enough for me to know that I'm probably not going to hear those words.

"This is all so awful, Riley," I manage. **"What's going to happen to him?"**

"The doctors say they're going to operate tomorrow and try to dislodge the last bullet, to stop the bleeding."

Shame burns my cheeks. I pretend that's what—who—I meant.

25 "Yes, the kid's going to be okay," I say with conviction, or, more truthfully, desperation. I can't get the boy's picture out of my head, can't stop thinking about his mother, sitting next to his hospital bed, waiting for him to open his eyes. I haven't even seen or touched my baby, and I already know I'd die for him or her.

"Let's hope," Riley says. "There are a lot of prayers for him, that's for sure."

30 She looks at me as she says this, really looks at me—and I slide my hands forward on the greasy table, close enough that she could grab them. She doesn't. There's no graceful way to change the subject, to turn it back to Kevin and me, but I don't have a choice. It's the reason I came here to Monty's in the first place. "So you saw that I called last night?"

"Yeah, I did. You didn't leave a message."

35 "Since when do I have to leave a message for you to call me back?"

Riley doesn't answer. It's suddenly like I'm being summoned to the principal's office—formal and furtive. I'm at the mercy of her judgment.

"Well, I wanted to ask you in person. For a favor." I clench my fists, gather my nerve. "I was wondering ... you know how the media can be. No offense." I was trying to go for a joke, at least
40 I thought I was, but it doesn't land that way. I quickly continue on. "I was hoping that maybe you could do a piece about Kevin, his side, you know? I saw that you're covering the story. You could talk to him and he could tell the viewers what really happened?"

But Riley's mouth twists like she drank something sour. She shakes her head even before she answers. "I can't ... I can't interview Kevin. It wouldn't be ... What I mean is, I couldn't be objective,
45 and that's my job. Professional objectivity." The words she mutters are white noise; it's the tone that hurts, so distant, robotic. She's wearing the Riley mask—that's what I call it when she shuts down her emotions like this. She's an expert at it. After Corey dumped her, or whatever happened between them last year, she acted like she was a-okay. Same responses every time I asked about it: "I'm fine." "It wasn't meant to be." "We were never that serious." The mask. But
50 I know better. Corey was good for Riley. He made her way less uptight. She loved him in a way that I'd never seen her love anyone, and as much as she may think she has people fooled, she's never fooled me.

"It's just ... I get it. I don't want you to do something you're not comfortable with, Riley, but it's already starting, everyone saying terrible things about Kevin. We need his side of the story out
55 there. It was a mistake, an awful mistake. It would help for people to understand that he isn't a bad guy, which he isn't. I mean, you know that."

But the way Riley is looking at me, it seems she doesn't know that. It seems like I have to allow for the possibility that she thinks my husband is a bad cop or, worse, a racist. Surely she can't think that? It's dawning on me that she expects me to be ashamed of my husband. **And that,**
60 **more than anything, starts to piss me off.**

"Well, let me ask you this: Would you do the interview if Kevin shot a white kid?"